

OCTOBER NEWSLETTER

14 OCTOBER 2022



Dear Families,

We would like to congratulate Elizabeth for her amazing achievement of becoming a finalist in the Individual Leadership Category of the Hesta Early Childhood Education and Care awards.

An article was published in the Newcastle Herald. You can read the article at this URL:

<https://www.newcastleherald.com.au/story/7913580/children-want-to-thrive-not-fight-for-survival/>

On Friday, 7th October at the HESTA Early Childhood Education and Care Awards Dinner in Canberra, Elizabeth was announced the winner!!!!!!

2022 Hesta Early Childhood Education and Care Awards

****WINNER****

Elizabeth Price
Gloucester Pre School & Early Years
Learning Centre



Elizabeth is recognised for her commitment to challenge and inspire the children in her care through natural learning environments.

Elizabeth worked for ten years to build a service grounded in nature pedagogy, and which reflected the unique community and environment. Developed in close consultation with the community, industry leaders and the children, this learning environment has supported children to solve problems, improve their physical development and increase their sense of social responsibility towards their peers.

With plans for the centre to become carbon neutral, Elizabeth led the centre's work on a sustainability project book. The book is a collaboration between staff, children, families and the wider community to develop new practices and skills that aim to minimise the centre's environmental footprint.

Elizabeth plans to further expand the centre to reflect the needs of the community and is working to deepen its positive environmental footprint.

(Excerpt from [Early Childhood Education and Care Awards 2022 | HESTA Super Fund](#))

If you would like to watch the award ceremony you can do so at this link:

https://fb.watch/g369X_sWYE/

PLAYGROUP DATES

Gloucester CWA...Tues 18 Oct
Coolongolook...Wed 19 Oct
Booral...Tues 25 Oct
Gloucester CWA...Tues 1 Nov
Coolongolook...Wed 2 Nov
Booral...Tues 8 Nov
Gloucester CWA...Tues 15 Nov
Coolongolook...Wed 16 Nov
Booral...Tues 22 Nov

DATES TO REMEMBER

- Whizzy the Water Drop Visit—Monday 24 Oct 12pm
- Committee Meeting—Thursday 27 Oct at 6pm
- Christmas Gathering/ Graduation Ceremony—Thursday 1st Dec at 6pm, Gloucester Public School
- Last day of Term 4: —
**Preschool Bookings—Monday 19th December;
*Long Day Care Bookings—Thursday 22nd December



Kareen Higgins,

Acting Director, Term 4, 2022

Elizabeth on long service Leave

What an exciting way for Elizabeth to finish off her year with us, as she is away on long service leave for all of Term 4, enjoying 500kms of the Bibbulum Track and Cape to Cape trails in Western Australia hiking solo.

I have been in my role as Assistant Director for 2 years now and I am inspired by Elizabeth's achievements and look forward to this experience of stepping up as Director in her absence. I ask for your help in this time, to support me in this role. Please know that I have an open door for any questions or queries. - Kareen

Welcome back Leanne

We are delighted to welcome Leanne Hunter back as an educator as she continues her studies in Cert III Early Childhood Education and Care. In Term 4 she will be working Mondays and Tuesdays throughout all the learning environments.



Leanne Hunter

Policies reviewed

- ◆ Code of Conduct
- ◆ Delegations & Responsibilities
- ◆ Incident Injury Trauma and Illness Policy
- ◆ Medical Conditions Policy

Absences

Please let the service know if your child is going to be away for the day. It helps with the daily management of the classrooms and allows families who require an additional day to book in and utilise the vacancy.

FATHERS' BREAKFAST IN THE PARK

Please join us for a 'Father's Breakfast in the Park' on Sunday 13^h November 2022, to engage in some interactive games with your children and enjoy a barbeque breakfast cooked by our committee members. You should receive an email and a notification on our App with more details.

How to contact us via email

Committee email address: glouc.preschool.committee@gmail.com

This email address can be used to contact the committee and will be monitored by the Vice President, Chontelle.

Emails to the committee will be treated as confidential and, as such, can be used only for matters, concern and issues that could not be resolved using the normal communication channels (e.g. with your child's Room Leader, the Assistant Director - Kareen, or the Director - Elizabeth).

The committee is not responsible for decisions regarding the day to day operation and management of the service. These include areas such as programming, curriculum decisions, staffing, equipment, meal planning, etc. All suggestions, ideas and feedback on these, and similar matters, need to go through your child's Room Leader, the Assistant Director, or the Director.

For issues concerning:

- ◆ Fees: accounts@gloucesterpreschool.com.au
- ◆ General information: admin@gloucesterpreschool.com.au
- ◆ Changes to booking/casual days: assistant.director@gloucesterpreschool.com.au
- ◆ Children special news, program ideas, etc.: staff@gloucesterpreschool.com.au
- ◆ Upper management: director@gloucesterpreschool.com.au

Working bee outcomes

You would have noticed some beautiful additions to our outdoor learning environments:

- ◆ Two new raised garden beds in the preschool outdoor learning environment.
- ◆ Dirt pit and rock garden in the EYLC outdoor learning environment.
- ◆ Grass mowed, whipper snipped, and weeds poisoned on and around 56 Hume St. Plus barricade fencing erected (Thanks to Deborah Sheeley... Gloucester Landscapes).

- ◆ Wooden stepping stones (Thank you for making them, Richard Squires).

A huge thank you to Kirsten, Brent and Jake (parents) and Elizabeth, Kayla and Jenny (staff members) and Sue and Allen (committee members) for attending our 'working bee'. Without your commitment and morning work, the jobs wouldn't have been completed!!!!



Celebrating 50 years of Gloucester preschool

Gloucester Pre School & Early Years Learning Centre celebrated its 50th anniversary on Saturday 24th September with an open day and dinner.

The Preschool paid tribute to the community members that realised the importance of a preschool program in the 70's and created a working committee that liaised with council and organised fundraisers to support the building of the Community Centre, which was shared with the Senior Citizens.

The Preschool classes commenced on the 19th September 1972 with 48 children enrolled.

The Preschool also paid tribute to long time staff members such as Mrs Heather Geater, Paddy Stevens, Di Macpherson, Dom Jacobs and current Director Elizabeth Price.

The night was also enjoyed by number of past and current committee members who have volunteered their time over many years to improve the service. The committee are an invaluable asset to the running of the preschool, from signing off on major improvements, attending working bees, to improve the outdoor learning environment and supporting the director and staff.

Elizabeth spoke on the night about the history and strong connections with the local community that has shaped the service into what it is today.

During the expansion of the service, the Preschool was awarded the 2018 Kidsafe National Playspace Design Award. The service has also been recognised in Elizabeth's win at the 2022 HESTA Early Childhood Education and Care Awards.

Thankyou to everyone that attended the open day and dinner. Thanks also to Nige Mc Photography for capturing the night.



COVID-19 Restrictions Lifted

After reflection of the Governments changes, i.e. lifting of all mask mandates and after reflection of the Governments changes, i.e. lifting of all mask mandates and communities current behaviours/practices, the service is lifting all Covid-19 restrictions.

Car park Courtesy

Please be courteous to other families and only use the carparking at the front of the service for drop off and pick up (i.e. there is designated pickup on the other side of the street for primary school children). The church's car park is not allowed to be used, as this is private property.

School Photos Information.

School photos – if you missed the deadline for ordering school photos through the service, families still have the option to order online until September 2023. Visit rememberthisphotography.com.au to order direct from Casey.

BANGGU ROOM NEWS

Over the past two weeks the children have been displaying an interest in taking care of the environment in our outdoor learning area and exploring our newly built mud pit which has brought many learning opportunities to provide nature play and exploration. They have shown an interest in looking after our gardens as they help to look after and maintain them through watering our plants to help them grow. Over the next few weeks, the children will be helping to design and plant our new vegetables in the garden. If you have a garden at home that interests your child or you would like to contribute to what vegetables you would like to see in our EYLC garden, we would love to hear from you.

From the Banggu team—Kayla, Tyler, Kareen and Dom



YAPII ROOM NEWS

Welcome back to term 4, the year is almost over! This term we will be continuing to follow up on the children's interest in the garden and outdoor learning environment. The children have been showing a lot of interest in keeping the outdoor areas tidy, helping to tidy the leaves, and

looking after the gardens, we will be planting some new seeds in the veggie gardens and nurturing them as they grow and provide us with food for our kitchen.

Continuing with our farm project book we have some eggs arriving on Friday that need to be cared for over the coming weeks before they hatch. We will be watching keenly and waiting to see what happens. I wonder what is inside. If you have any more photos of your animals at home we would still like to add them to our book as we continue to explore this interest.

From the Yapii Team—Kathryn, Lucy & Kareen



GAWUL ROOM NEWS

During Term 3, the Gawul Room children exhibited care and appreciation for their environment. They used recycled materials for their artwork and made new paper out of paper scraps. They learned about different ways to minimize our rubbish so it doesn't end up in our environment, causing flooding and killing our wildlife. Some children brought their pets to show how they care for animals. They also planted seeds in the vegetable garden, which they are observing the growth through watering them and counting the leaves coming out. They are enjoying watching the bees pollinate the flowers of our citrus trees, discovering cocoons, and making friends with our resident blue tongue lizards in the garden. In Term 4, We will continue to learn more ways to care for our environment through our sustainable practices, and we will be learning about our interdependence with other living creatures in our environment.

From the Gawul team—Sharon, Rashelle and Olivia



DAPIN ROOM NEWS

Welcome to Term 4 everyone! Jac, Jasmine and Jenny are very excited to share this busy term with your amazing children. There are many fun learning experiences planned for the children including continuing our project books from Term 3, 'Healthy Lifestyles' and 'Our world', with the addition of another term project book 'All About Eggs'. If your child has expressed an interest in something over the preschool break that we could expand on at preschool, please send us an email or come and talk to Jac or Jenny about it.



For 17 children in our Dapin room this will be their final term of preschool. These children will participate in 'Big School Time' as they prepare for their transition into kindergarten. This will involve 30 minute focused learning sessions each morning from approximately 9.45am - 10.15am each day starting in Week 2 (17th October) to week 8 (2nd December). The learning experiences will cover a range of topics from understanding what big school is about (developing emotional confidence), numbers and counting, sequencing, language, shapes, colours, and name writing. Jac will facilitate these sessions on Mondays and Tuesdays while Jenny will facilitate them from Wednesday to Friday. If you have any concerns about your child being school ready, please don't hesitate to talk to Jac or Jenny. If your child is going into kindergarten in 2023 there is a section of our transition to school statement for families to complete. We would appreciate if you could complete this and return it to me as soon as possible please.



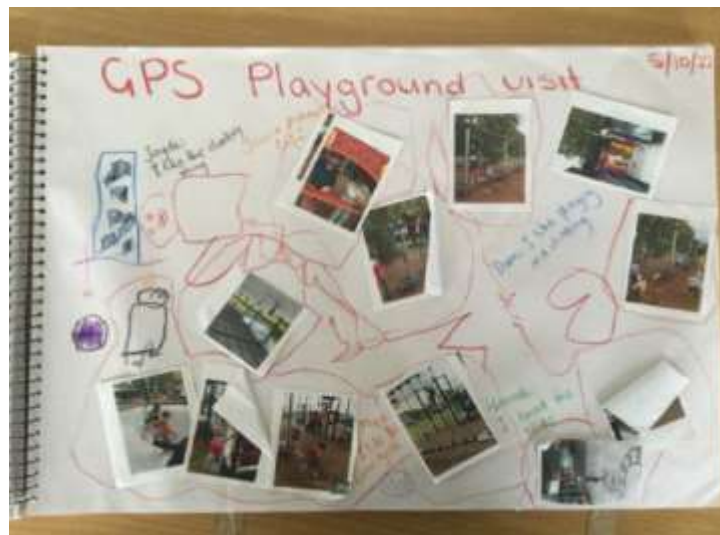
This term will be a very busy one both in and out of preschool for the children, so it is important to remember to find time to just relax as a family and to enjoy spending time with your children.

From the Dapin team:
Jenny, Jacklyn and Jasmine



Vacation Care NEWS

This Vacation Care, the children were given many opportunities to explore to wider community through visits to the park for a Teddy Bears' Picnic, and the holiday fun day in Minimbah Gardens to participate in natural crafts, face painting, colourful hair braiding, boomerang throwing and a talk from ambulance NSW about snake bites. We also visited the play ground at the Gloucester Public School, which gave the children going to school next year the opportunity to look around and get excited about a new learning environment. We also had some fun days expressing ourselves through dress ups, crazy hair and sharing our talents.





Banana Oatmeal Cookies - Makes 12 cookies

(AUTHOR: mykidslickthebowl.com/banana-oatmeal-cookies/)

Ingredients:

- ◆ 110g butter (softened)
- ◆ 50 g brown sugar $\frac{1}{4}$ cup
- ◆ 85 g banana 1 medium banana peeled
- ◆ 1 teaspoon vanilla
- ◆ 100 g quick cook oats 1 cup
- ◆ 75 g flour $\frac{1}{2}$ cup
- ◆ $\frac{1}{2}$ teaspoon baking powder
- ◆ 1 teaspoon cinnamon
- ◆ choc chips Quantity is up to you $\frac{1}{2}$ -1 cup



Method:

1. Cream the butter and sugar, I use my stand mixer for this but you can use a handheld beater or a wooden spoon and some elbow grease.
2. Add the banana and vanilla, my stand mixer beats the banana into the creamed butter and sugar, if you are making these cookies by hand you will need to mash the banana before adding it.
3. Add the flour, oats, baking powder and cinnamon. Mix until combined, I do this in the stand mixer.
4. Fold in the chocolate chips.
5. Optional: This cookie dough is easier to work with if you chill the dough for around 15-20 mins, but it is possible to make the cookies without chilling.
6. Heat your oven to 180 degrees celsius.
7. Scoop your cookie dough into 12 even portions, roll into balls, place on a lined baking tray, then flatten them gently with a fork.
8. Bake at 180 degrees celsius for 10 minutes until lightly golden brown on the edges. The cookies will be soft, cool for 5 minutes before removing from the baking tray.

Tips

Flour: This recipe

Brown Sugar: This recipe

Butter: This recipe

Choc Chips: These can be left out if desired.



REMEMBER YOUR CHILD'S SUNSCREEN

With the weather warming up and the UV index rising, please remember to apply sunscreen to your child in the morning and tick your child's name off on our "Parent Sunscreen Application Checklist" (located at the sign-in bench for each room).



All children must bring a broad-brim sun hat to school each day and wear clothing that covers their shoulders and tops of their arms.

Items such as caps, singlet tops and dresses that don't give adequate sun protection should not be worn to pre-school.



Hats and T-shirts \$10



National Water Week 2022:



Whizzy the Waterdrop Visit

Gloucester Preschool & Early
Years Learning Centre

The visit consists of a 30 minute program on
Monday 24 October 2022 at 12:00pm
Includes a discussion on water, the reading of a story
about water and a visit from Whizzy.

A colorful poster for the "Garage Sale Trail". At the top, a pink arrow points right with the text "Garage Sale Trail". Below this, the words "Sell, Shop, Learn" are written in large, stylized pink cursive. The poster is decorated with various items like a video game console, a water bottle, a t-shirt, a skirt, a fanny pack, and a pair of roller skates, all with price tags. In the center, it says "FEATURING TWO BIG WEEKENDS OF GARAGE SALES ACROSS AUSTRALIA 12-13 & 19-20 NOV 2022". Below that, it says "TRAIL TUTORIAL ONLINE WORKSHOPS" and "REGISTER FOR FREE AT GARAGESALETRAIL.COM.AU". At the bottom, there is a QR code, the NSW Government logo, the NSW EPA logo, and the Midcoast Council logo. A small cartoon character with a flame for a head is holding a sign that says "GARAGE SALE HERE!". On the left side, the hashtag "#GARAGESALETRAIL" is written vertically. At the bottom left, there is a circular logo with the words "REUSE", "REPAIR", and "RE-LOVE" around a globe, with the text "it's the circular economy" above it.